

Sporting Jax Boys Invitational

August 22-23, 2026 - St. Johns, FL

Welcome to our tournament guide for the Sporting Jax Boys Invitational! We put this together to make planning easier by gathering tournament, travel, lodging, and venue information in one place. As additional information becomes available, we'll send updated versions.

1. Tournament Quick Start

Event:	Sporting Club Jax Boys Invitational
Team:	Savannah United 17/18B Travel
Dates:	Sat-Sun, August 22-23, 2026
Venue:	Veterans Park, 1332 Veterans Pkwy, St. Johns, FL 32259
Age/Format:	U9 - 7v7 - Group to Knockout
Stay-to-Play:	Required for teams traveling over 90 miles
Drive:	~130 mi / ~2h 15min via I-95 South
Parking:	Free on-site. Arrive early. Grass overflow available.

2. Parent Action Items

DO THIS THIS WEEK: Book hotel on GotSport Travel Portal. Cancel by Aug 14 for full refund.

COMING SOON: Check game schedule ~Aug 8-15 via GotSport.

COMING SOON: Check weather forecast ~Aug 18-19.

BEFORE LEAVING HOME: Pack using the checklist. Review tournament rules.

3. What We Know and What We're Waiting For

CONFIRMED: Official - Sporting Club Jax, Aug 22-23 at Veterans Park. U9 (7v7). Stay-to-Play required. Points (3/1/0) and 6-tier tiebreakers. Rules published. Confirmed - SU 17/18B Travel attending. Premier included.

PENDING CONFIRMATION: Game schedule (1-2 weeks before), U9 field assignments, bracket format, team hotel block.

4. Tournament Overview

Weekend youth soccer tournament hosted by Sporting Jax Academy. Our U9 team will compete in 7v7 group play on Saturday with knockout rounds on Sunday.

Official website: sportingjaxacademy.com/BoysInvitational

5. Travel and Arrival Planning

Route: I-95 S to Exit 329 (CR-210 W) to Veterans Pkwy. ~130 miles.

Departure times below target arrival by 7:15am (45 min before 8am game for check-in, warm-up, and coach instructions).

Scenario	Time	Depart by - Arrive 7:15am
Best case (no traffic, one stop)	~2h 15min	5:00am
Normal (traffic, gas + food)	~2h 30min	4:45am
Heavy traffic / construction	~3h 00min	4:15am

Recommendation: Overnight stay Friday night avoids the early drive. If driving day-of, leave by 5:00am for best case.

Player Report Time: Pending confirmation. Plan for at least 45 minutes before first game.

6. Lodging and Stay-to-Play

OFFICIAL TOURNAMENT REQUIREMENT: Teams traveling over 90 miles must book through the GotSport Travel Partner Hotel Program. Our team is ~130 miles from the venue.

Official Partner Hotel

Holiday Inn Express & Suites Fleming Island	
Rate:	\$162/night + tax (\$324+ for 2 nights)
Rooms:	25 Queen/Queen available
Includes:	Free hot breakfast, free parking, outdoor pool, pet-friendly (\$25), Kids Eat Free, free WiFi
Distance:	~27 miles / 37-40 min drive to Veterans Park
Check-in/out:	Fri Aug 21 / Sun Aug 23. Cancel by Aug 14 for full refund.
Payment:	Credit card to hold, charged at check-in
Book:	system.gotsport.com/stores/1903604Y4

Note: GotSport listed 'Distance from Event' (5.73 mi) does NOT match actual Google Maps distance (~27 mi / 40 min).

Nearby Alternatives (Not Partner)

Hampton Inn & Suites Jax South - Bartram Park

~\$93-100/nt. Free hot breakfast (6-10am), free parking, WiFi, outdoor pool, fitness center, pet-friendly. 3.5 mi / 6 min to venue.

Holiday Inn Express Jax South - Bartram Park

~\$91-97/nt. Free breakfast buffet, free parking, WiFi, indoor pool, pet-friendly (\$40/night). 3.5 mi / 6 min to venue.

Residence Inn Marriott Jax South/Bartram Park

~\$118-133/nt. Free hot breakfast, free parking, WiFi, kitchen suites, lobby lounge, fitness center. 8 mi / 10 min to venue.

Important: These alternatives are not on the GotSport Stay-to-Play portal. Pending Confirmation - the team manager will confirm with the tournament director whether a proximity exception is available. Do not book outside the housing system until confirmed.

Information current as of July 29, 2026. Rates subject to change.

7. Weather and Heat Planning

More than 3 weeks out: It is too early for a reliable daily forecast for August 22-23. Typical late-August conditions in St. Johns, FL:

High temps:	Upper 90s F
Heat index:	105-114 F - likely heat advisory
Rain chance:	Afternoon thunderstorms common (40-60%)
Humidity:	High - expect heavy, humid air
Morning games:	Significantly cooler, lower lightning risk

What This Means: Hydrate 24 hours before. Morning games will be significantly more comfortable. Afternoon storms may cause delays. The tournament uses a 30-minute lightning delay clock.

Check the forecast again around August 18-19 for a reliable day-by-day forecast.

8. Venue, Parking, Fields and Amenities

Official Tournament Information: Veterans Park, 1332 Veterans Parkway, St. Johns, FL 32259.

Official Field Map: docs.google.com/presentation/... (link in email)

Parking:	Free. Veterans Pkwy and Island Park Dr lots. Fills early on tournament days. Grass overflow available. Arrive 30-45 min early.
Fields:	6 full-size (11v11) - 5 grass + 1 turf, all lighted. Multiple configurations for 7v7, 9v9. U9 fields: Pending Confirmation.
Amenities:	Concessions (long lines at peak), restrooms (multiple locations), clubhouse, AED, playground.

9. Team Communication

Official schedule:	GotSport
Team updates:	PlayMetrics Messages / Email
Tournament logistics:	Parent Manager
Soccer questions:	Coach
Urgent changes:	Team chat / text

10. Coach Updates (Coming Soon)

This section will be updated once our coaches release arrival times, uniform details, and any team-specific instructions. Parents do not need to act on these items - they are for reference once confirmed by the coaching staff.

11. Age-Appropriate Player Guidance

Tournament weekends are exciting and demanding for young players. Here are some practical reminders.

- Prioritize sleep - early bedtimes
- Keep meals familiar, bring simple snacks
- Encourage regular hydration throughout the day
- Limit exhausting hotel-pool activity before games
- Bring quiet activities for downtime
- Expect physical and emotional fatigue
- Keep postgame conversations positive and brief
- Allow coaches to provide soccer instruction
- Emphasize effort, teamwork, learning, and enjoyment

12. Packing Checklist

Player Gear:

Both uniform kits Cleats Shin guards Labeled water bottle Extra socks Warm-up/training gear Dry clothes Recovery shoes/sandals Personal medications

Weather & Hydration:

Water (plenty) Electrolytes Sunscreen SPF 50+ Cooling towel Rain gear Small fan Plastic bags for wet gear

Parent Sideline:

Folding chairs Shade Umbrella Cooler Snacks Portable charger Wipes Trash bags Sibling activities

Emergency:

First-aid supplies Ice packs Insurance info Emergency contacts Prescriptions

13. Tournament Rules Parents Need

Official Tournament Information. Full rules: link in email.

Points: Win = 3, Tie = 1, Loss = 0

Game length: 25-minute halves for U9-U12

Mercy rule: Match ends when a team leads by 6 at halftime or later

Substitutions: Unlimited - goal kicks, throw-ins, kickoffs, halftime, injury

Zero tolerance: No referee abuse. Immediate removal + min 1-game suspension

Heading: Not allowed for U12 and younger

Water breaks: Mandatory mid-half at 85F+ - expected all weekend

Forfeit: 5 minutes late. Minimum 5 players to start (7v7)

Weather: 30-minute delay clock. Post-halftime stoppage = completed game

Championship: No overtime - straight to penalty kicks if tied

Tiebreakers (in order):

- | | |
|-----------------------------|--|
| 1. Head-to-Head | Result between tied teams (disregarded if 3+ teams tied) |
| 2. Goal Differential | GF minus GA. Max 4 goals per game. |
| 3. Goals For | Total scored. Max 4 goals per game. |
| 4. Goals Against | Fewest allowed (no cap) |
| 5. Shutouts | Most clean sheets |
| 6. Penalty Kicks | FIFA Kicks from the Penalty Mark |

The 4-goal cap on Goal Differential and Goals For is the most commonly misunderstood rule. Applies per game, not per tournament.

14. Nearby Family Resources

Closest to the Bartram Park hotel area. Information current as of July 29, 2026.

Forgot Something?

Academy Sports + Outdoors - 9041 Southside Blvd, Jax. (904) 363-6720. Mon-Sat 8a-10p, Sun 9a-9p. ~8-10 min from Bartram Park.

Dick's Sporting Goods - 10390 Midtown Pkwy, Jax. (904) 642-4299. Mon-Sat 9a-9p, Sun 10a-7p. ~12-15 min.

Food Nearby

St. Johns Town Center - multiple family-friendly restaurants near hotels. ~10-15 min from Veterans Park.

Pharmacy & Urgent Care

CVS Pharmacy - 13970 Village Lake Circle, Jax. (904) 260-0550. ~5 min from Bartram Park.

15. Weekend Itinerary

Friday, August 21

Travel to Jacksonville/St. Johns area. Check into hotel. Early bedtime for players. (Recommendation - avoids 4:45-5:00am Saturday departure)

Saturday, August 22 - Group Play

Pending Confirmation. Schedule released 1-2 weeks before. Expect 2-3 group play games. Player report time at least 45 minutes before first game.

Sunday, August 23 - Knockout Rounds

Pending Confirmation. Schedule depends on Saturday results. Teams that advance play in semifinals/finals. All teams play at least one game Sunday.

16. Quick Reference

Tournament: Sporting Jax Boys Invitational

Team: SU 17/18B Travel

Dates: Aug 22-23

Venue: Veterans Park, St. Johns FL

Parking: Free | Arrive 30-45 min early

Drive: ~2h 15min | I-95 S to Exit 329

Stay-to-Play: Required | GotSport portal | Format: U9 7v7 Group to KO

Heat: 105F+ heat index | Hydrate, shade, sunscreen

17. Final Next Steps

1. Book hotel on GotSport Travel Portal by August 14. Cancel by Aug 14 for full refund.
2. Watch for game schedule ~Aug 8-15 via GotSport. Will be shared in PlayMetrics.

3. Check weather forecast around August 18-19 for reliable day-by-day conditions.
4. Pack using the checklist - include heat and rain preparedness.
5. Updated guide with game times, field assignments, and coach notes will be sent when schedule releases.

Go, Savannah United!

Looking forward to a fun weekend of soccer. Safe travels, and we'll send an updated guide as soon as schedules are released.